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You Are a Citizen of God's Kingdom

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You Are a Citizen of God's Kingdom

"But our citizenship is in heaven" — Philippians 3:20

You are a citizen of God's kingdom. This identity lifts your eyes beyond the temporary concerns of earth to the eternal realities of heaven. Your allegiance has shifted. You no longer live as one bound to the passing systems of this world but as a representative of a higher, unshakable realm. Though you walk the streets of this earth, your true citizenship resides in heaven, and your life is to reflect the values, priorities, and purposes of your King.

What does it mean to be a citizen of God's kingdom? The acrostic **CITIZEN** unfolds the privileges, responsibilities, and calling that accompany this transfer of loyalty. God:

Chose you for His unshakable kingdom
Installed you as a priest in His holy kingdom
Told you the secrets of the kingdom in the Bible
Illuminated you to be His light to the world
Zapped you free from the kingdom of darkness
Entrusted you with the keys to the kingdom
Named you as an ambassador for His kingdom

Every dimension inspires contemplation and compels us toward a faithful response.

**As a citizen of God's kingdom,
God chose you for His unshakable kingdom.**

You have been deliberately selected. "But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people of his own, so that you may proclaim the virtues of the one who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light" (1 Peter 2:9). This choice was not random but purposeful, setting you apart to display the excellence of the One who called you. In a world of shifting kingdoms and uncertain futures, you stand secure in God's eternal reign.

**As a citizen of God's kingdom,
God installed you as a priest in His holy kingdom.**

You have been given a sacred role. "You have appointed them as a kingdom and priests to serve our God, and they will reign on the earth" (Revelation 5:10). As a priest, you are called to worship, intercede, and represent Christ in your daily life. Your life becomes an offering of praise, and your prayers carry the concerns of others before the throne of grace.

**As a citizen of God's kingdom,
God told you the secrets of the kingdom in the Bible.**

Divine insight has been granted to you. "He replied, 'You have been given the opportunity to know the secrets of the kingdom of heaven, but they have not'" (Matthew 13:11). Through Scripture, the Holy Spirit unveils truths about God's reign, His character, and His ways. These kingdom secrets provide wisdom for living, discernment in decision-making, and hope amid earthly turmoil.

**As a citizen of God's kingdom,
God illuminated you to be His light to the world.**

You are called to shine in darkness. "You are the light of the world. A city located on a hill cannot be hidden. ... In the same way, let your light shine before people, so that they can see your good deeds and give honor to your Father in heaven" (Matthew 5:14, 16). Your words, actions, and character are meant to reflect the light of Christ, drawing others toward the Father through visible goodness and integrity.

**As a citizen of God's kingdom,
God zapped you free from the kingdom of darkness.**

A decisive deliverance has taken place. "He delivered us from the power of darkness and transferred us to the kingdom of the Son he loves" (Colossians 1:13). You have been rescued and relocated. The chains that once held you have been broken, and you now live under the gracious rule of the Son. This freedom empowers you to walk in the light and reject the patterns of your former domain.

As a citizen of God's kingdom, God entrusted you with the keys to the kingdom.

Spiritual authority has been placed in your hands. "I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven. Whatever you bind on earth will have been bound in heaven, and whatever you release on earth will have been released in heaven" (Matthew 16:19). Through prayer and faithful obedience, you exercise authority in alignment with heaven's purposes—binding what opposes God's will and releasing what advances His kingdom.

As a citizen of God's kingdom, God named you as an ambassador for His kingdom.

You represent the King. "Therefore we are ambassadors for Christ, as though God were making his plea through us. We plead with you on Christ's behalf, 'Be reconciled to God!'" (2 Corinthians 5:20). As an ambassador, your conduct, words, and attitudes should reflect the dignity, grace, and mission of your heavenly homeland. You carry the message of reconciliation to a world in need of the gospel.

You Are the Light of the World

Jesus gave His followers this clear kingdom identity:

"You are the light of the world. A city located on a hill cannot be hidden" (Matthew 5:14).

As citizens of God's kingdom, you are called to shine in the darkness through good deeds, godly character, and bold witness so that others may see your life and glorify your Father in heaven.

Practical "Because" Statements

These truths translate into purposeful living:

- Because God **chose** me, I can proclaim His virtues boldly.
- Because God has **installed** me as a priest, I can worship freely, intercede boldly, and serve as a representative of Christ.
- Because God **tells** me the secrets of the kingdom, I can live by biblical wisdom.
- Because God **illuminates** me, I can shine through good deeds.

- Because God **zapped** me free from darkness, I can walk in the light.
- Because God **entrusted** the keys to the kingdom, I can exercise spiritual authority in prayer.
- Because God **named** me as an ambassador, I can plead with others to be reconciled to God.

Living It Out

This week, pray intentionally for opportunities to represent Christ in your daily spheres—whether at home, work, or in your community. Look for moments to speak of His goodness, demonstrate His love through service, or extend the invitation of reconciliation. Let your citizenship shape your choices and conversations.

As you close this chapter, let the reality of your heavenly citizenship fill you with hope and resolve. You are part of an eternal kingdom that cannot be shaken. Live, therefore, with the dignity, boldness, and compassion that befit a citizen of the realm of light, bringing glory to the King who has called you by name.

Prayer

“King of kings, help me live as a faithful citizen and ambassador of Your kingdom. May my life reflect Your light, authority, and reconciling love in all that I do. Amen.”

Memory Verse

“But our citizenship is in heaven—and we also eagerly await a savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ” (Philippians 3:20).

Conclusion: Walking Worthy of Your Calling

In Christ, you are a new creation. The old has gone, and the new has come. This is not a temporary change of status but a profound and lasting transformation that redefines who you are at the deepest level. As you have journeyed through these pages, you have been reminded again and again of the glorious realities that are yours in Him: you are a beloved child of God, a saint with a new nature, a vital member of the body of Christ, and a citizen of His eternal kingdom. Let these truths shape every area of your life—for your deepest joy and for the glory of God.

The journey of becoming who you already are in Christ is both immediate and ongoing. It begins with faith—believing what God declares about you—and continues through daily surrender, renewed thinking, and obedient living. There will be moments of triumph and seasons of struggle, yet you do not walk alone. The same God who called you is faithfully at work within you to conform you to the image of His Son.

Return to this book often. Use the acrostics as anchors for meditation. Speak the practical “Because” statements aloud when doubt, temptation, or weariness presses in. Let the Scriptures renew your mind and strengthen your heart. Share these truths with others—whether in your family, your church, or your sphere of influence. The message of identity in Christ is not meant to be kept private but proclaimed and lived out in community, bringing encouragement to fellow believers and hope to those still searching.

Walk worthy of your calling, therefore, as God’s child, a saint, a member of His body, and a citizen of His kingdom. Live with the security of a loved child, the freedom of a forgiven saint, the connectedness of a functioning member, and the dignity of a heavenly ambassador. In doing so, you will experience the abundant life Jesus promised and bring honor to the One who redeemed you.

Final Benediction

“Now may the God of peace himself make you completely holy and may your spirit and soul and body be kept entirely blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. He who calls you is trustworthy, and he will in fact do this” (1 Thessalonians 5:23-24, NET).

May the Lord bless you, keep you, and cause His face to shine upon you as you walk in the fullness of your new identity in Christ. To Him be the glory forever. Amen.

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We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

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Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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